

Kevin Patton

Curriculum Vitae

Arts and Science Hall Room 205
University of Nebraska at Omaha
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Academic Appointments

2022 - Present	Instructor, University of Nebraska at Omaha
2020	Instructor, Kansas State University
2018 - 2021	Adjunct Professor, University of Nebraska at Omaha

Education

University of Nebraska-Lincoln
PhD, Philosophy, August 2024

University of Nebraska-Lincoln
MA, Philosophy, May 2023

University of Nebraska at Omaha
BA, Philosophy *cum laude*, *Phi Beta Kappa*, May 2012

AOS

Epistemology, Value Theory, Metaethics

AOC

Philosophy of Language, Philosophy of Religion, and Metaphysics.

Peer Reviewed Publications

1. “We Need a Belmont Report for AI” in *AI & Society* (2025).
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s00146-025-02461-0>

Teaching Experience

University of Nebraska at Omaha, Instructor

Graduate Courses

1. CACT8215: Values and Virtues
2. CACTXXXX: Leadership Ethics in Practice (in development)

Undergraduate Courses

1. PHIL3960: Kant: Ethics and Values
2. PHIL3700: Space, Time, and Reality
3. PHIL3230: The Philosophy of Video Games
4. PHIL3070: Leadership Ethics in Practice
5. PHIL3060: Values and Virtues
6. PHIL3050: Ethical Theory
7. PHIL2300: Human Values in Medicine
8. PHIL2030: Introduction to Ethics
9. PHIL1210: Critical Reasoning
10. PHIL1020: Contemporary Moral Problems
11. PHIL1010: Meaning of Life

Thompson Learning Community Member

1. PHIL1010: Meaning of Life
2. PHIL2030: Introduction to Ethics

Kansas State University, Instructor

1. PHIL365: Medical Ethics

University of Nebraska-Lincoln, Instructor

1. PHIL106: Introduction to Ethics
2. PHIL110: Introduction to Logic

Mentoring and Academic Supervision

University of Nebraska at Omaha, Instructor

Primary Reader for Master of Arts in Critical & Creative Thinking

1. *From Volunteers to Vision: A Framework for Sustainable PTO Leadership and Operations*, Fall 2026 - Spring 2027

Acted as primary reader for a masters student in the Creative and Critical Thinking MA program at UNO. Duties include regular meetings with the student to discuss progress, the offering of comments and constructive criticism on drafts

of her project, and other guidance as needed. The final deliverable being a multimodal tool-kit aimed at connecting leadership theory with practical export.

FUSE Grants

1. *Moral Instinct: An Evolutionary and Neuroscientific Centered Notion of Morality*, Awarded Fall 2025

Mentored a student in the successful development of a FUSE Grant proposal and am now supervising the funded project, including guidance on the literature review, research paper, and presentation at the university's research fair.

Independent Studies

2. *PHIL3960 Introduction to Ethics Teaching Assistant*, Fall 2025

Supervised an independent study where the student served as my teaching assistant, with the student assisting in the development of course materials, assessments, and pedagogical strategies.

3. *PHIL3960 Kant: Ethics and Values*, Spring 2024

Supervised an independent study on Kant's ethics and value theory. The student produced three papers, including a final essay on Korsgaard's Kantian ethics that is intended as the basis for their writing seminar paper.

Honors Contracts

1. *PHIL2030 Introduction to Ethics*, Fall 2023

Supervised an honors contract for a student requiring a detailed reading of G.E. Moore's *Principia Ethica* to assess his intuitionism. The student submitted weekly reading summaries and ultimately produced a research paper concluding that Moore's intuitionism was internally inconsistent. This final paper is also intended to serve as the foundation for the student's required philosophy writing seminar paper.

2. *PHIL2300 Human Values in Medicine*, Fall 2022

Supervised a project on cultural approaches to SIDS prevention, culminating in a student-led lecture to the class. This work was conducted to support the student's larger research efforts in preparation for their medical school applications.

3. *PHIL2300 Human Values in Medicine*, Fall 2022

Supervised a project on accessibility and economic impacts of IVF, culminating in a class lecture. This work supported the student's broader research focus on the biological and ethical aspects of medical care for their medical school application.

Summer Reading Group, 2023 - Present

1. Directed an annual voluntary summer reading program with students, providing group instruction and facilitating advanced philosophical discussions to support continuous student intellectual development between semesters.

Service

University

1. Collaborated with AI-CCORE to develop robot personas, interactive content, and multimedia for their public AI Exhibit, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2026 - Present
2. Moderator for Student Research and Creative Activity Fair, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Spring 2026

Department

1. Member, Visiting Professor Search Committee, Department of Philosophy, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Spring 2026
2. Co-lead on Kiewit Luminarium Partnership for Worldviews Display, Fall 2026
3. Collaborated with Amy Schindler to have multiple philosophy displays in Criss Library, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Spring 2026
4. Writing Group Organizer, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Spring 2026 - Present
5. Colloquia Co-organizer, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2025 - Present
6. Community of Practice Organizer (Department Reading Group), Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2025 - Present
7. Lead Trainer on Generative AI Training, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Fall 2024 - Present
8. Co-Chair of Web Development, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024 - Present

9. Co-Chair of Advertising and Promotion, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024 - Present

Profession

1. Paper Reviewer, Artificial Intelligence, Ethics, and Society Conference, 2025
2. Chair for Session of 2025 American Philosophical Association Division Meeting, 2025

Community

1. Judge and Moderator for Omaha Ethics Bowl, Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2026, 2025, 2022

Advisor

1. Advised the undergraduate Philosophy Group to help bring in guest speakers and host events, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2025 - Present
2. Faculty Advisor, UNO Comfy Casual Gaming Club, 2025 - Present
3. Faculty Advisor, UNO eSports Team, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024 - Present

Professional Development

1. Faculty Observation of Teaching, University Committee for the Advancement of Teaching, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Fall 2025
2. Faculty Observation of Teaching, University Committee for the Advancement of Teaching, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Fall 2024
3. Generative AI for Educators Certificate, Google, 2024 [[link](#)]
4. AI Essentials, Google and Coursera, 2024 [[link](#)]
5. The AI Advantage Certificate, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024 [[link](#)]

6. The AI Jumpstart Certificate, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024 [[link](#)]

Presentations

1. “Epistemic Value Revisited” Invited Speaker by the Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska at Omaha, April 2025
2. “Value, Meaning, and Machines” Invited Presenter for *AI Summit*, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Omaha, NE March 2025
3. “Open Source Database Indexing as a Means of Assisting Non-Native English Speaking Students in Learning Philosophy.” *The 21st Biennial AAPT Conference on Teaching Philosophy*, Saginaw, MI. July, 2016

Research Grants and Awards

1. Digital Learning Grant for Course Revamp, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Fall 2025
2. Affordable Content Grant Approval, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024
3. The OpenAI Challenge Approval, University of Nebraska at Omaha, Fall 2024 - Present
4. Tier 2 AI Jumpstart Grant, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024
5. Online Program Grant for the creation of the course *PHIL3070: Leadership Ethics in Practice*, University of Nebraska at Omaha, 2024
6. Hinman Scholarship and Fellowship Award Philosophy Department, University of Nebraska-Lincoln, 2017
7. Teaching Assistantship, University of Nebraska-Lincoln, 2013-2017
8. Outstanding Teaching Award, Teaching Recognition Award from UNL Student Organization, 2013

Professional Memberships

American Philosophical Association

American Association of Philosophy Teachers

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence

Graduate Coursework

Epistemology and Metaphysics

- Theory of Knowledge, Albert Casullo
- Seminar, The Epistemology of Disagreement, Aaron Bronfman
- Seminar, Epistemic Norms as Social Norms, David Henderson
- Quine's Philosophy, Edward Becker
- Seminar, The Metaphysics of Dispositions, Jennifer McKittrick
- Seminar, Grounding, Jennifer McKittrick
- Metaphysics, Joseph Mendola
- Seminar, Philosophy of Mind, Joseph Mendola
- Reading Group on Natural Kinds, Edward Becker

Philosophy of Language and Logic

- Formal Logic, Reina Hayaki
- Seminar, Fictional Names, Reina Hayaki
- Philosophy of Language, Edward Becker

Ethics and Ethical Theory

- Seminar, Ethical Theory and Reasons, Mark van Roojan
- Advanced Ethics, Aaron Bronfman
- Seminar, Internal and External Reasons, John Brunero
- Seminar, Metaethics, Aaron Bronfman

History

- Ancient Philosophy, Harry Ide
- Kant's Critical Philosophy, Colin McLear
- Self-Knowledge in Kant & Early German Idealism, Colin McLear

Dissertation

Title: The Value of Knowledge and its Problems
Committee: David Henderson (committee chair)
William Melanson (reader)
Aaron Bronfman (reader)
Edward Becker (reader)

This dissertation answers the three value problems in epistemology. These three problems require an answer as to how knowledge is more valuable 1) than mere true belief, 2) any of the proper subsets of knowledge, and 3) in kind than that which falls short of knowledge. The methodology used to provide an answer to these problems relies on the arguments put forth in a rarely discussed paper from Ward Jones. In short, the Jonesian approach can be summed up as the view that epistemic axiology and analysis ought to be kept separate. The Jonesian framework instead looks outside of the necessary and sufficient conditions of knowledge to find properties of knowledge which, though contingent, can explain the distinctive value of knowledge. This framework, though remarkably robust, requires going against what I consider to be the orthodox approach to the problems. This orthodox approach relies on two axiological assumptions. The first is that every component of an analysis on knowledge must provide independent value to knowledge. The second assumption is that the value of knowledge cannot be derived from factors excluded from an analysis of knowledge. Once these assumptions are appropriately discarded, the Jonesian view has a straightforward answer to the first problem. Answering the second requires assessing Jonathan Kvanvig's claim that a satisfied Gettier condition contributes no independent value. While I agree with Kvanvig regarding a satisfied Gettier condition, I will argue that an unsatisfied Gettier condition is not likewise neutral; it contributes disvalue. With that distinction in place, a solution to the second problem follows immediately. The third value problem, however, is a different kind of problem altogether. Answering it requires not only the Jonesian framework, but also a novel account of how we determine final value. Once this account is offered, a Jonesian answer to the tertiary problem follows immediately. This dissertation closes by applying the Jonesian framework to an argument that claims there can be no modal conditions on knowledge due to such conditions failing to help answer the value problems. This claim will be found wanting.